PRD v1: Choose your refund after cancellation

Let users pick instant wallet or bank refund when a waitlisted train ticket is actually cancelled

Product: cnftkt (train booking app)	**Owner:** Rahul **Status:** Draft v1	**Target release:** To be decided with the technical team

1. Problem

Today, when a train ticket is still waitlisted after booking, the app asks where a refund should go (wallet or original payment source) right then, usually about 30 days before travel, and the choice can't be changed. (Confirmed tickets are not affected: the choice is shown when the user cancels.) When the waitlisted ticket is later cancelled, many users are stuck with the 7-working-day bank refund while they need money now. The wallet is instant and withdrawable, but users avoid it, partly from a fear of locked money. Evidence: lived by me and one friend (waitlisted ticket of about ₹2,700 auto-cancelled 8 hours before travel, no spare cash to rebook). To be broadened in user interviews.

2. Goal and how we'll measure it

- **Goal:** more users get their refund instantly instead of waiting up to 7 working days.
- **Main metric:** wallet opt-in rate = users who choose the wallet ÷ users shown the choice after cancellation. Baseline unknown; target is a rise over the baseline.
- **Guardrail:** refund-related support contacts per 1,000 cancellations. Should stay flat or fall.

3. Who it's for

Anyone whose train ticket on cnftkt is waitlisted at booking and later cancelled, automatically from the waitlist or by themselves. It matters most to travellers who need the money quickly to book another trip.

4. User stories

- **Main:** As a student whose waitlisted ticket was cancelled 8 hours before travel, I want to choose an instant wallet refund after the cancellation, so that I can rebook right away instead of waiting up to 7 working days with no spare cash.
- As a traveller whose ticket was cancelled automatically, I want an alert with the refund choice, so that I know I had a faster option.
- As a traveller who worries my money will get stuck, I want to see that wallet money can be withdrawn to my bank, so that I feel safe choosing it.
- As a traveller who prefers the original payment source, I want that to stay an easy choice, so that I never feel pushed into the wallet.

5. Requirements

Must have (version 1)	Nice to have (later)	Not doing now
• Stop asking the refund question after booking a waitlisted ticket; ask only after cancellation • Alert after every cancellation of a waitlisted ticket (automatic from the waitlist, or by the user) • Choice screen: wallet (instant) or original payment source (up to 7 working days) • Wallet option says money can be withdrawn to the bank anytime • Bank option stays easy to pick	• Suggest the user's last choice next time • Tracker showing where the refund is • Keep the short "refund to wallet is instant" line at booking	• Fixing the locked-coupon problem (goes on the roadmap as the next item) • Faster bank refunds (depends on banks) • Redesigning the wallet

6. Assumptions and open questions

Assumptions (to test in interviews)

- Choosing after cancellation raises wallet use more than the booking-time line does.
- Users fear locked money because the wallet is little advertised and other apps lock wallet money.
- Users usually open the app to check PNR status on the travel date.
- Most affected users are students and young travellers with limited money.

Open questions

- How fast is a withdrawal from the wallet to the bank, and are there charges? (Not known)
- If the user ignores the alert: proposed to hold the refund until the app is opened, with reminders. Not confirmed. Risk: this could take longer than the current 7 working days, so a time limit may be needed.
- What share of users choose the wallet today? (No data yet)
- If a user cancels a waitlisted ticket himself, is a new refund choice shown at that moment today? (To confirm)

7. Design sketch

Rough sketch of the choice screen, shown right after cancellation. Neither option is pre-selected.

